# AIX Lab-Atlas

Onboarding, Track 2: Claude Design

| | |
|---|---|
| **For** | A designer who has never used these skills, working in Claude Design |
| **You will end with** | Skills loaded in Claude Design, one practice screen, one reviewed artifact |
| **Time** | About 45 minutes |
| **Status** | Not tested yet. Anthropic's help article does not say whether Claude Design can load custom skills. This guide gives two ways and asks you to record which one works. No licence yet: pilot use only. |

## 1. What this is

AIX Lab-Atlas is a set of 30 skills for Claude. A skill is a folder of instructions that teaches Claude one design job, such as writing a product brief, analysing interview transcripts or auditing a screen. Each skill asks for context first, shows you a plan, tags every claim with its evidence, and ends by asking you to review.

This guide takes you from the GitHub link to your first reviewed artifact. Every step that can go wrong has a **Check** line that tells you whether it is safe to continue. The work lives in RPalis/AIXLab-Atlas, on the branch `update-readme-retire-competitors-duplicate`.

> **NOTE** This guide has no screenshots. Button names change when Claude and GitHub update their screens. If a name does not match yours, look for the closest one and write the difference in the feedback form. That is a defect in the guide, not a mistake by you.

## 2. What you need before you start

| Item | Used for | Link | Needed? |
|---|---|---|---|
| GitHub account (free) | Opening the repository | github.com/signup | Routes A and B |
| Claude account on a plan that includes Claude Design (Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise) | Using Claude Design. On Enterprise an administrator must enable it. | claude.ai/design | Yes |
| A text editor | Opening a `SKILL.md` to copy it | Notepad, TextEdit or any editor | For Method 2 |

> **NOTE** Never use client material. Your practice project must use an invented product idea.

## 3. Safety rules (read once)

A skill can write files, and a first session must not damage real work or invent research.

| Rule | What to do | Why |
|---|---|---|
| G1 Scope | Work only inside `atlas-practice`. Never point a skill at a client project, a production repository or real research. | A skill can write files. |
| G2 Secrets | Never paste passwords, API keys, tokens, client names or real user data into any chat. Sign in to services in your browser only. | Claude never needs them here. |
| G3 Permissions | Keep Claude on its default, which asks before editing. Do not switch on bypass, auto-accept or "dangerously skip permissions". | You approve every change. |
| G4 Plan first | A skill must show a plan and wait before it writes a file. If it does not, type: stop, show me your plan first. | The main safety net. |
| G5 No invented evidence | Every persona, quote, number or competitor fact must trace to a source you gave or the skill cited. Otherwise it must say "unknown". Treat untagged claims as invented. | Fabricated research is the failure these skills prevent. |
| G6 Human review | Read each output before you run the next skill. | Skills draft. You decide. |
| G7 Stop rule | Stop and tell the observer if a file appears outside `atlas-practice`, Claude asks for a password or token, or you are stuck for more than 5 minutes. | The three ways a session goes wrong. |

## 4. Get the files

Your observer tells you which route applies. Do only that route.

### Route A: you were invited to the private repository

1. Open your email and find **RPalis invited you to collaborate on RPalis/AIXLab-Atlas**. Click **View invitation**.
2. Sign in to GitHub with the account the invitation was sent to, then click **Accept invitation**.
3. On the repository page, click the branch button, which says `main`, and choose `update-readme-retire-competitors-duplicate`.

> **CHECK** The file list includes `skills`, `README.md`, `install.sh` and `ONBOARDING.md`. "404 Not Found" means you are signed in to the wrong account: click your picture, check the username, switch.

Shortcut while signed in as the invited account: this link downloads the branch as a ZIP straight away.

```
https://github.com/RPalis/AIXLab-Atlas/archive/refs/heads/update-readme-retire-competitors-duplicate.zip
```

### Route B: the repository is public

1. Open https://github.com/RPalis/AIXLab-Atlas.
2. Click the branch button, which says `main`, and choose `update-readme-retire-competitors-duplicate`.

### Route C: you were sent a ZIP file

1. Save the ZIP somewhere you can find it. Unzip it: double-click on a Mac, or right-click then **Extract All** on Windows.

### Download the files (routes A and B)

1. With the branch `update-readme-retire-competitors-duplicate` selected, click the green **Code** button above the file list, then **Download ZIP**.
2. Open the downloaded file and unzip it.

> **CHECK** The unzipped folder contains `skills`, `README.md` and `install.sh`.

## 5. Open Claude Design and load the skills (not tested yet)

Claude Design is Anthropic's design tool at claude.ai/design. It is in research preview and builds prototypes, slide decks and one-pagers from a conversation. Anthropic's help article on its design systems (support.claude.com) does not say whether it can load custom skills. Do the steps below in order and write down what you see. What you find decides which method works for you.

1. Open claude.ai/design and sign in with your Claude account. It is available on the Pro, Max, Team and Enterprise plans. On Enterprise an administrator must switch it on. If you cannot see Claude Design, tell the observer which plan you are on.
2. Open **Settings**, and also look inside a new project. Write down every menu named **Skills**, **Customize**, **Instructions**, **Knowledge** or **Add files**.
3. **Method 1, upload.** In the unzipped files, open `onboarding/starter-skill-zips`. It holds `help.zip`, `brief.zip` and `interview-analysis.zip`. Where you found a skills or instructions option, upload `help.zip`. If you only found an attach button, attach it to a new project. Write down whether it was accepted.
4. **Method 2, paste (always possible).** Open `skills/help/SKILL.md` in a text editor, select all, copy, and paste it into a new Claude Design chat. Add the line: Follow these instructions for this session.

> **NOTE** Methods 1 and 2 load one skill at a time. For each later skill, upload its ZIP the same way or paste its `SKILL.md`. Pasting does not carry the skill's template and reference files, so tell the observer if a skill asks for one.

## 6. Check that it worked (not tested yet)

1. Method 1: in a new chat type:

```
Use the AIX Lab-Atlas help skill and tell me which skill to run first.
```

1. Method 2: after the paste, type:

```
I am starting a new product idea and have no files yet. Which skill should I run first?
```

> **CHECK** Claude names a skill and gives a reason. With no project files it should say `setup` or `brief`. If it ignores the pasted instructions, or says it does not know the skill, tell the observer which method you used.

> **NOTE** Claude Design may not give skills a file system, so skills that write project files (`setup`, `prototype`, `package`) cannot save files there. Each skill now says so and returns its output in the conversation instead. Use the research and thinking skills first: `brief`, `interview-analysis`, `problem-statement`, `brainstorming`, `information-architecture`, `ux-benchmark`, `usability-test-plan`, `persona`, `journey` and `audit`. Build, install and Figma steps need Claude Code.

## 7. Connectors

You do not need any connector for this track. If a skill asks for Figma or Jira, tell it you cannot connect one here, and never paste a token into the chat (rule G2).

## 8. First run: plan, execute, audit (not tested yet)

Use an invented product idea. Everything happens in Claude Design.

### Step 1: Plan

1. Load `brief` (upload or paste its `SKILL.md`), then type: `Use the brief skill. Project: <your idea in one sentence>. Starting point: brand-new idea.`
2. Read the plan Claude shows before it asks any question.

> **STOP IF** If the skill starts writing a document before showing a plan, type: stop, show me your plan first. Then tell the observer which skill it was (rule G4).

### Step 2: Execute

1. Answer the questions one at a time. Say "I don't know" wherever you do not know.

> **CHECK** Every "I don't know" appears in an Unknowns list in the output. It must not turn into an invented answer.

### Step 3: Test the evidence guardrail on purpose

1. Load `persona` the same way, run it in `card` mode, and give it no research.

| What happens | Meaning |
|---|---|
| The skill refuses to invent users and asks for research or interviews. | Correct. The guardrail works. |
| The skill writes a finished persona with names, ages and quotes. | Defect. Tell the observer straight away. |

### Step 4: Make one screen, then audit it

1. Ask Claude Design to make one screen for your invented idea.

2. Load `audit` the same way and run it in mode `craft`. Give it a screenshot of the screen, or the export the app offers. Which of these it accepts is not known yet, so note what worked.
3. Beside each finding write one word: **accept**, **reject** or **unsure**. Nothing is fixed until you say so.
4. Close the project. Fill in the feedback form.

## 9. Do you have a design system?

Advice, never a blocker. Claude Design builds its design system from sources you give it: a codebase, slide decks or documents, and brand assets such as logos, colour files and typography specs. You can ask for one in chat and manage them in **Settings > Design systems**. In Claude Code, the `/design-sync` command reads tokens and components from a React component library. These points come from Anthropic's help article.

| Your situation | What to do | What you get |
|---|---|---|
| **A. Tokens or components in code** | Give Claude Design the codebase as a source (link or upload the repository). For a React component library you can also run `/design-sync` in Claude Code. | A design system read from your real code. |
| **B. A brand, no system** | Upload your brand assets (logo, colour file, typography spec) or a brand-guide deck. | A design system built from your brand sources. |
| **C. A Figma library only** | How Claude Design reads Figma is not known yet. Export the brand assets from Figma and use route B. | A design system from the exported assets. |
| **D. Nothing yet** | Use Claude Design's default. Label every screen "placeholder tokens". | Placeholder styling, clearly marked. |

> CHECK Ask Claude: which of these values came from my sources and which did you choose? A correct answer separates the two.

## 10. If something goes wrong

| What you see | Likely cause | What to try |
|---|---|---|
| No Claude Design at claude.ai/design | Your plan does not include it, or an Enterprise admin has not enabled it | Tell the observer your plan. Ask your administrator. |
| No skills or instructions menu | Claude Design may not support skill upload | Use Method 2: paste the skill's `SKILL.md` into the chat. |
| A ZIP is rejected | ZIP is not an accepted file type here | Use Method 2, and tell the observer the accepted file types. |
| Claude ignores the pasted instructions | The instructions were not understood as a task | Paste again, then type: Follow these instructions for this session. |

| What you see | Likely cause | What to try |
|---|---|---|
| Claude says it saved a file | Claude Design may have no file system | Ask it to show the file content in the chat. Never trust a claim that a file was written. |
| A skill writes before showing a plan | Plan-first step skipped | Type: stop, show me your plan first. Tell the observer which skill. |
| Claude asks for a password or token | It should not | Do not enter it. Stop and tell the observer. |
| GitHub shows "404 Not Found" | Wrong account | Switch to the account that was invited. |

## 11. Tell us what happened

Fill in `onboarding/FEEDBACK-FORM.md` right after your session, while you remember it. Honest answers help most, including "I got confused here". It asks which route and track you used, how long the check in the install section took, where you first hesitated, whether any skill wrote before showing a plan, whether the persona test refused correctly, and whether you would use these skills on real work. Observers: run the session with `onboarding/OBSERVER-SCRIPT.md` and log findings in `onboarding/FINDINGS-LOG.csv`.

## Links

| Link | What it is |
|---|---|
| https://github.com/RPalis/AIXLab-Atlas | The repository |
| claude.ai/design | Claude Design |
| support.claude.com Claude Design design systems | Anthropic's help article on Claude Design design systems |
| github.com/signup | Create a GitHub account |